

Economics

(A Level, AQA (7136))

Do you want to understand how the world really works? Then Economics is the subject for you. Economists face one central dilemma: the needs and desires of humans are near limitless whilst the resources available to them are finite. This means that humans must make choices about their consumption. Economics is the study of these choices: What should we produce? How should we produce it? For whom should it be produced?

There is always a significant economic context to current affairs and historical events both here in the UK and worldwide. Therefore, Economics complements many other A level subject choices whether that be the humanities, languages or science. You'll be required to analyse and interpret data, but also to present logical, coherent arguments concerning economic policy at an individual and governmental level. You will leave the course a more rounded, worldly person, with a deep understanding of human behaviour in a world of scarcity.

Entry requirements:

GCSE grade 5 in Mathematics and grade 5 in English.

Course Content

Units	%	When?	Content
Paper 1: Markets and Market Failure	33.3%	June of Year 13	This unit focuses on microeconomics: the choices made by individual economic agents (individuals and firms) in markets. Microeconomic models such as demand and supply, perfect competition, monopoly, the operation of the price mechanism and the causes of market failure are central to this part of the course. Other key models relate to the operation of labour markets, wage determination and causes of inequalities in the distribution of income and wealth.
Paper 2: The National and International Economy	33.3%	June of Year 13	This unit focuses on macroeconomics: how national and international economies function together. A range of economic objectives will be considered, including growth, controlling inflation, tackling unemployment and achieving satisfactory trade balances. The impact and effectiveness of current UK government policies to deal with these issues will be taught, as well as considering alternative policies and approaches.
Paper 3: Economic Principles and Issues	33.3%	June of Year 13	This synoptic paper assesses content from across the course. It has multiple-choice questions which test knowledge and a case study section which is a great opportunity to apply what you have learned in both micro and macroeconomics.

Career Links

Economics is a well-respected A Level that appeals to many employers in both the public and private sectors. Economics is also regarded as an entry qualification for courses at elite universities in areas such as PPE (Politics, Philosophy and Economics), Accounting, MORSE (Mathematics, Operations Research, Statistics and Economics), Management Science and International Relations. Many of our A level students go on to study for degrees at Russell Group Universities in related subjects and then progress into careers in accountancy, actuarial science, finance, management, and public policy.

For more information please contact Mr Langford in the Business and Economics Department.